

What Can Each Study Claim?

Topic 3.2 · TODAY'S PROBLEM

Suppose a student wants to know whether a new tutoring center raises test scores.

Plan A: Compare this year's test scores for students who choose to attend the center with scores for students who do not attend.

Plan B: Recruit 40 student volunteers, then use a coin flip to assign each volunteer either to attend the center or not to attend. Compare their later test scores.

Two plans for studying tutoring

Plan	Who?	Groups?	Response
A	Students	Choose	Scores
B	40 volunteers	Coin flip	Scores

FIRST TAKE (5 min, on your sheet)

Which plan gives stronger evidence that the center raises scores? Name the feature behind your choice.

- DOK 1** (a) Identify Plan A as an observational study or experiment, and do the same for Plan B. State why for each.
- DOK 2** (b) Name one lurking variable that could make Plan A's groups differ, and explain how it could be related to both attendance and test score.
- DOK 3** (c) Which plan could support the claim that the center raises scores? Cite the design feature that settles it and explain what Plan A's result could mean instead. Then state one conclusion Plan B still could not support about students beyond the volunteers.

Video + follow-along: u3_lesson2_live.html (scan the code)

Finish (a)–(c) after the video. Turn in your sheet.

